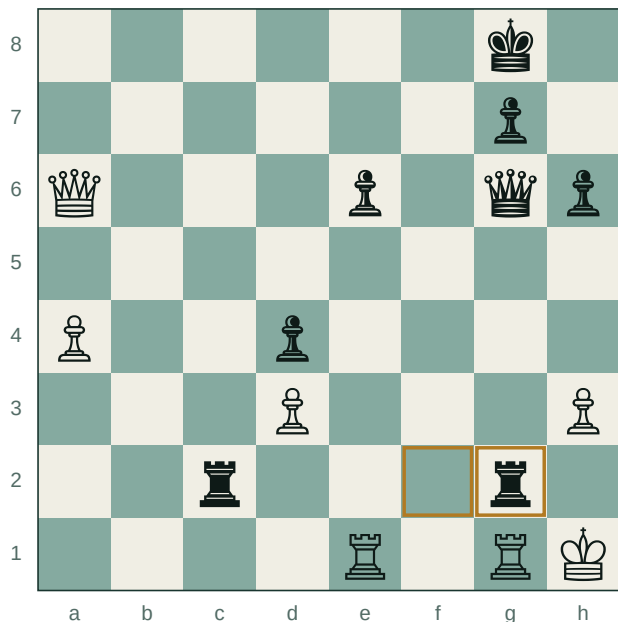


Intermediate moves: White, move 28

Intermediate moves

White to move



Previous move: 27...Rxf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Qa8+ Kh7 29. Rxf2 Rxf2 30. Qxf2

28.Qa8+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From a8 it attacks king on g8 and rook on g2. Recorded reply: **28...Kh7**.

29.Rxf2 The rook captures the rook on g2. From g2 it attacks queen on g6 and rook on c2. Recorded reply: **29...Rxf2**.

30.Qxf2 The queen captures the rook on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

HOW TO LOOK

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.